

collaborative effort between students and businesses. The corporate world has also jumped on this unique way of providing a forum for nurturing creative ideas with solid business skills. Often, these innovation labs are left alone, or largely untouched, by the incumbent parent, perhaps following Christensen's advice,

With few exceptions, the only instances in which mainstream firms have successfully established a timely position in a disruptive technology were those in which the firms' managers set up an autonomous organization charged with building a new and independent business around the disruptive technology.

In the twenty-first century, the innovation lab concept has been embraced most famously by Google, which encourages creativity and innovation beyond an employee's current position. The company has created the Google Garage²⁶ as a (somewhat) formal structure in which employees can pursue innovations with others in the company. This has resulted in projects, such as its autonomous vehicles effort, that Google has grown organically in the hopes of providing additional future revenue.

A key feature that needs to be reinforced from Christensen's quote is the need to "set up an *autonomous* organization." Just setting up an innovation lab within a company is not a guarantee of success. These labs must be allowed to function as autonomous organizations, without the tunnel vision of existing business and profit models.